#A The kind field indicates this is a secret
#B Give the secret a name and a namespace
#C The secret has two fields with base64-encoded values

You can also define secrets at runtime using `kubectl`. Run the following command to define a secret for the Natter API database username and password:

```
kubectl create secret generic db-password -n natter-api \
    --from-literal=username=natter \
    --from-literal=password=password
```

> **TIP** Kubernetes can also create secrets from files using the `--from-file=username.txt` syntax. This avoids credentials being visible in the history of your terminal shell. The secret will have a field named username.txt with the binary contents of the file.

Kubernetes defines three types of secrets:

- The most general are *generic* secrets, which are arbitrary sets of key-value pairs, such as the username and password fields in listing 11.10 and the previous example. Kubernetes performs no special processing of these secrets and just makes them available to your pods.
- A *TLS* secret consists of a PEM-encoded certificate chain along with a private key. You used a TLS secret in chapter 10 to provide the server certificate and key to the Kubernetes ingress controller. Use `kubectl create secret tls` to create a TLS secret.